

The AI Now Institute, founded in 2017 and based at New York University, addresses the potential negative impacts of algorithmic applications on marginalized communities. It has a diverse team of experts from disciplines such as computer science, sociology, law, ethics, and policy, the institute dedicates itself to understanding the social implications of artificial intelligence (AI) and related technologies. The key to their mission is the investigation of how algorithms and data may perpetuate or exacerbate social inequalities. Through a tremendous amount of research, the AI Now Institute goal is to find biases and discriminatory practices embedded within AI systems, advocating for equitable and accountable AI development and deployment. Their yearly reports serve as significant contributions, giving analyses of the current state of AI technology and its societal implications. For example, their 2019 report underscored the imperative for enhanced transparency and accountability in AI systems to mitigate discrimination against vulnerable populations, including people of color, women, and low-income communities. Also, the institute gets involved with policymakers, industry leaders, and civil society organizations to shape ethical guidelines and regulatory frameworks for AI technologies.

By participating in public discourse and policy debates, they embody practices that prioritize fairness, transparency, and accountability in AI development and deployment. Additionally, the AI Now Institute organizes workshops, conferences, and public events to raise awareness about the social implications of AI. These efforts bridge the gap between academic research and practical interventions, driving meaningful change in the design and implementation of AI systems. Overall, the AI Now Institute plays a crucial role in advancing critical discourse and action on the ethical and social dimensions of AI technologies, contributing to the creation of a more equal and just society in the age of big data and machine learning.

References:

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2. AI Now Institute. (2019). AI Now Report 2019. Retrieved from https://ainowinstitute.org/AI_Now_2019_Report.pdf
3. Crawford, K., & Whittaker, M. (2018). AI Now Report 2018. Retrieved from https://ainowinstitute.org/AI_Now_2018_Report.pdf